

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Babies Learn to Talk

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 17

No.	Sentence
1	Before their first word, babies enter a stage called _____ and produce simple sounds.
2	To make particular sounds, they must learn to control their _____.
3	One presenter guesses that babies may learn by _____ what adults do.
4	Babies first divide the continuous _____ into words.
5	They then connect those words with things in their _____.
6	As they listen, babies must recognise where _____ begin and end.
7	In English, a word often starts with a _____, which may help babies find its beginning.
8	In one example, a child drops an _____ at the start of a word.
9	A further task is to connect a word with the _____ it names.
10	Several possible things may fit a spoken word, creating _____ for the child.

11 **What does the early discussion suggest about babies' production of speech sounds?**

- A They wait until they know a word's meaning before trying its sounds.
- B They explore how different mouth movements produce sounds.
- C They rely on hearing sounds without practising mouth movements.
- D They use the same mouth shape for each sound they attempt.

12 **In the expert's account, what must a child do before attaching meanings to words?**

- A Identify the objects that adults are likely to name.
- B Copy the exact sounds made by an adult speaker.
- C Learn which syllables carry the strongest stress.
- D Separate the continuous flow of speech into words.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

- 13 **Why may stress help a baby identify word boundaries in English?**
- A A stressed syllable often signals the start of a word.
 - B A stressed syllable usually signals the end of a word.
 - C Each English word contains just one syllable.
 - D Every English word begins with the same sound.
- 14 **What does a child's use of "raffe" for "giraffe" illustrate?**
- A The child has confused the animal with another object.
 - B The child has added a stressed syllable to the word.
 - C The child has left out an unstressed opening syllable.
 - D The child has changed the meaning of the whole word.
- 15 **What is implied by the alternative explanation "my sminge"?**
- A The same child pronunciation might reflect a different division of the sounds.
 - B The child had already learnt the meaning of the word "machine".
 - C The adult was certain about exactly how the child understood the word.
 - D The child was trying to correct the adult's pronunciation of "machine".
- 16 **How is matching words to objects presented from adult and child perspectives?**
- A Both find it difficult because speech has no clear sound patterns.
 - B Adults find it difficult, while children do it without effort.
 - C Both rely mainly on copying the speaker's mouth movements.
 - D Adults do it almost automatically, while children face a harder task.
- 17 **What can reasonably be inferred about a child hearing "cup" with several objects nearby?**
- A The child can use the word's sound alone to identify the object.
 - B The child must always choose the object closest to the speaker.
 - C The child may be unsure which object the speaker intends.
 - D The child is unable to learn the word until the objects are removed.